FOR TEACHERS AND PARENTS

TEACHER & PARENT PACK

Fair-play detective puzzles for ages 8 to 12 (KS2)

The Conkerbury Detectives are four friends and a sausage dog who solve village mysteries. Every case is a **fair-play** puzzle: children read the evidence, weigh up witness statements, use maps and measurements, and rule suspects out one by one until only one answer is left.



In this pack: this guide · role cards · the classroom edition of the free taster case with answers and certificate · extension questions · KS2 links · World Book Day costumes and props.

RUNNING IT IN CLASS (ABOUT 45 MINUTES)

5 min: read the story aloud (page 1 of the case) and share the mission. **25 min:** groups of 4 or 5 solve it with role cards and one copy of the case per group (or one per child). **10 min:** each group shares its answer code and *the clue that ruled each suspect out*. **5 min:** reveal the answer page and read "What happened next".

SUPPORT

Three hints, each giving away a bit more. Pair readers. Do the WHO grid together as a class first, then let groups do the WHERE grid.

CHALLENGE

No hints allowed. Groups must write one sentence of evidence for every cross. Then try the extension questions.

ONLINE ANSWER CHECKER (OPTIONAL)

At **conkerburydetectives.co.uk/check.html** (choose **Free printables**). There is nothing to sign up for. A wrong code gets a hint about which clue to look at again, never the answer.

THE OTHER FREE FILES

- **Free taster case:** *The Case of the Flying Sausage Dog*: a complete 6-page case plus certificate (in this pack too)
- **Detective Starter Kit:** ID card, case notebook, elimination grid, cipher wheel with 3 messages, fingerprints, memory and observation games
- **Christmas mini case:** *The Case of the Muddled Stockings*: a logic-grid case with hints, answers and a certificate
- **Colouring pages:** four line-art pages of the detectives and the village

Free to print and photocopy for home and classroom use. Please don't sell or re-upload them.

ABOUT THE BOOKS

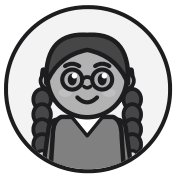
The cases come from the world of **The Conkerbury Detectives** by Inspector Cuthbert Conkerworth. Book 1, **The Case of the Missing Conker Champion**, has 30 cases: **https://www.amazon.co.uk/dp/B0HQ1LMJGX**. Book 2, *A Conkerbury Christmas*, is coming soon. Nothing in this pack is taken from the books: every case here is new.

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CLASSROOM EDITION

DETECTIVE ROLE CARDS

Cut out one set per group. Anyone can play any role.



PRIYA

The Brains · RECORDER

You keep the group's elimination grids. Read the story aloud. Every time someone says "cross them out!", ask: **which clue says so?** You write the final answer code.



OLLIE

The Legs · INTERVIEWER

You are in charge of the witnesses: **W1 Mr Fenwick** and **W2 Mr Jolly**. Read their statements aloud in their voices, then tell the group exactly who or where each one rules out.



FFION

The Measurer · CHIEF MEASURER

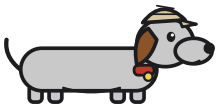
You are in charge of **E2, the high hook**, and **E3, the stiff spine**. Compare each suspect's height with 130 cm, and each hiding place's length with 1.8 m.



ALFIE

The Lookout · MAP READER

You are in charge of **the map** and **A1, Alfie's lookout**. Find which hiding places can only be reached along the pond path, and explain it to the group.



BISCUIT

The Nose · EVIDENCE SNIFFER

You are in charge of **E1, the footprints**. Check every suspect card for their shoes. In a group of 4, the Recorder does this job too.

Group rule: nobody may cross out a suspect until the person in charge of that clue has read it out and the group agrees. The Recorder has the final word on the grid.

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FREE CASE FILE · NOT IN THE BOOKS

THE CASE OF THE FLYING SAUSAGE DOG

SATURDAY · KITE DAY ON THE VILLAGE GREEN · 12.30 TO 1.00

It was Conkerbury Kite Day, the windiest Saturday of the year. The village green was full of kites: diamond kites, box kites, a kite shaped like a goldfish and one shaped like Mr Fenwick's prize marrow.

But the best kite of all belonged to the after-school Kite Club. They had spent six whole weeks making it out of brown tissue paper, garden canes and a LOT of glue. It was ***a giant sausage dog***, with floppy paper ears, a red collar and a tiny paper deerstalker. Its name was **Sir Biscuit the Magnificent**.

The real Biscuit was not sure about it. He growled at it every time the wind made its ears flap.

At half past twelve, Mrs Lark hung Sir Biscuit on the big hook at the front of the Kite Club tent, ready for the competition at two o'clock. Then everyone went off for lunch.

At one o'clock, Mrs Lark came back with a cup of tea. The hook was empty. **Sir Biscuit the Magnificent had vanished.**

"Six members of Kite Club were on the green at lunchtime," said Mrs Lark, looking very pale. "And the competition starts in one hour!"



The poster Kite Club put up at 1.05.

DIFFICULTY ●●○○○

Rookie to Junior · ages 8–12 · about 30–45 minutes



PRIYA: "One hour," said Priya, opening her notebook. "That's plenty of time. Ollie, you talk to the witnesses. Ffion, measure everything. Alfie, we need a map. Biscuit … try not to growl at anyone."

YOUR MISSION

Work out **WHO** took Sir Biscuit the Magnificent between 12.30 and 1.00, and **WHERE** they hid it. Use the suspect cards, the map and the clues. All you need is a pencil. A real detective never guesses: every cross needs a clue!

MEET THE CONKERBURY DETECTIVES



Priya, the Brains, writes down every clue. **Ollie**, the Legs, knows everyone and gets the statements. **Ffion**, the Measurer, never goes anywhere without her tape measure. **Alfie**, the Lookout, draws maps and spots patterns. **Biscuit**, the Nose, wears a tiny deerstalker and tries to eat the evidence.

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THE SUSPECTS

Six members of Kite Club were on the green between 12.30 and 1.00. One of them took Sir Biscuit the Magnificent. Each suspect has a **code word**: you'll need it for the answer code.

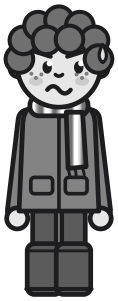


A MAX THORNBURY

Year: Year 6
Shoes: Wellies
Height: 146 cm
At lunchtime: "Eating my sandwiches. On my own."

"I don't even LIKE sausage dogs. Well, maybe a bit."

Code word: **BREEZE**



B HARVEY PIKE

Year: Year 6
Shoes: Wellies
Height: 152 cm
At lunchtime: "Looking for my lucky kite string."

"I lose everything. I lost my lunch once. It was in my hat."

Code word: **CLOUD**



C IVY CHEN

Year: Year 5
Shoes: Trainers
Height: 141 cm
At lunchtime: "Working on a story for my newspaper."

"A missing kite? This is FRONT PAGE news!"

Code word: **THUNDER**

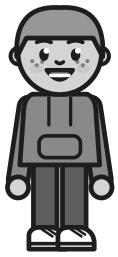


D RUBY OKAFOR

Year: Year 6
Shoes: Smart shoes
Height: 148 cm
At lunchtime: "Walking round the green, thinking."

"I was the one who glued the ears on. I'd never take him."

Code word: **RAINBOW**



E NOAH PRICE

Year: Year 5
Shoes: Trainers
Height: 134 cm
At lunchtime: "Watching the clouds. Did you know clouds can weigh as much as a hundred elephants?"

"I didn't see anything. I was looking UP."

Code word: **DRIZZLE**



F TOMASZ NOWAK

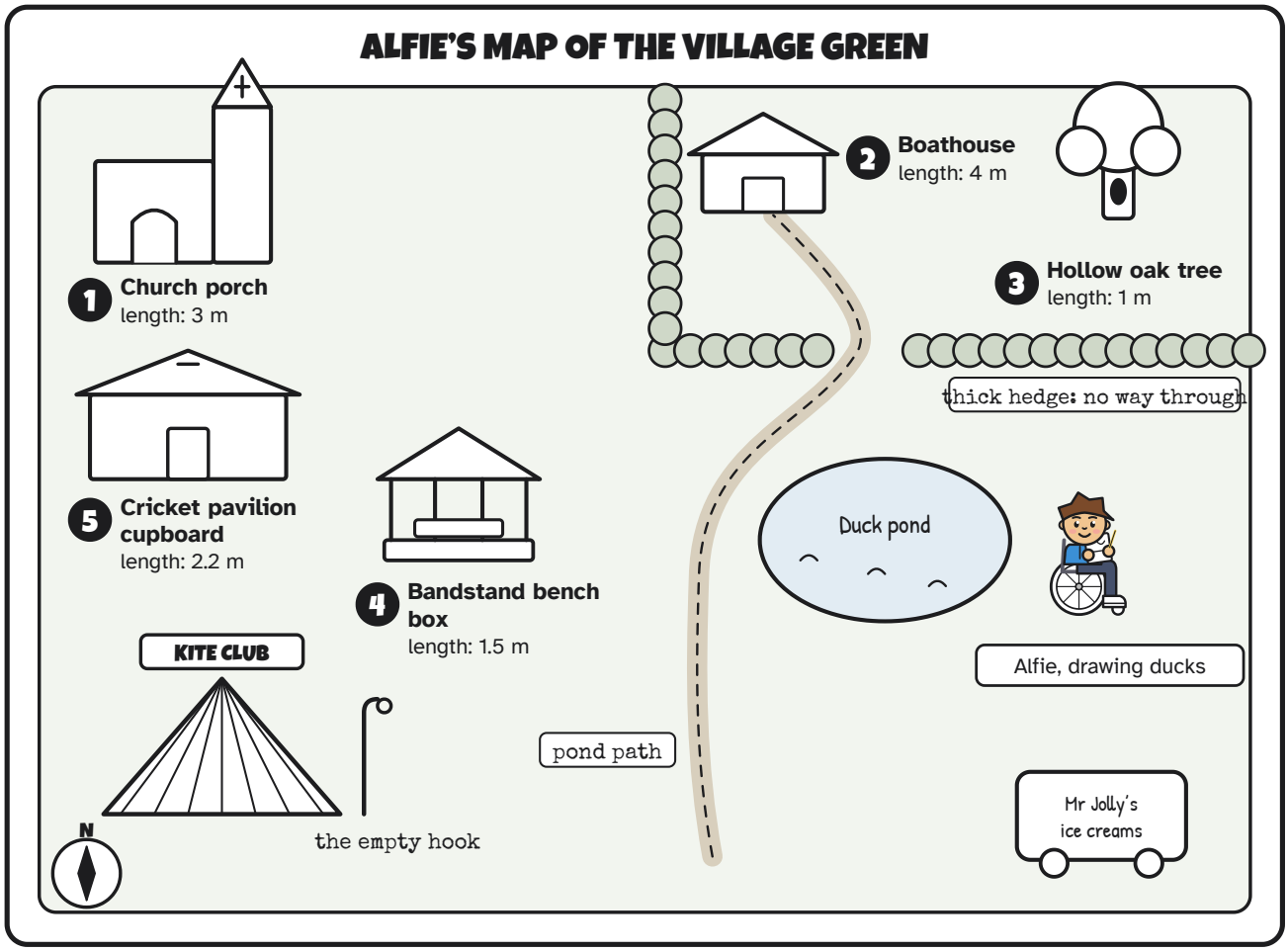
Year: Year 3
Shoes: Trainers
Height: 124 cm
At lunchtime: "Playing tag. I won. I think."

"I helped paint his nose! It's the best bit."

Code word: **PUDDLE**

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THE SCENE



Alfie drew this map. The **thick hedge** fences off the boathouse (2) and the hollow oak (3): the only way to reach them is along the **pond path**. Each hiding place has its length written underneath. Sir Biscuit the Magnificent is **1.8 m** long.

THE EVIDENCE

E1 THE FOOTPRINTS

In the soft mud under the hook, Biscuit sniffed out a set of fresh footprints. They have a zigzag pattern: **the person who took the kite was wearing trainers**.

E2 THE HIGH HOOK

Ffion measured the hook: it is **1.6 metres** off the ground. She tested it with a broom. "You need to be **at least 130 cm tall** to lift the kite off that hook," she said.

E3 THE STIFF SPINE

Sir Biscuit is **1.8 metres long**, and his spine is a stiff garden cane. He can't bend or fold. **He can only be hidden in a place that is longer than 1.8 metres.** The lengths are on Alfie's map.

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THE WITNESSES



W1 MR FENWICK

"I locked the church porch at twelve o'clock, and the key has been in my pocket ever since. Nobody has been in there. Nobody!"



W2 MR JOLLY

"Ivy Chen was at my ice-cream van from half past twelve until one o'clock. She was writing about my new flavour, Bramble Ripple, for the Conkerbury Chronicle. She tried all six free samples. Twice."



A1 ALFIE'S LOOKOUT

"I was by the duck pond from twelve until quarter past one, drawing the ducks. I could see the whole pond path the entire time. **Nobody walked along it.**"

THE ELIMINATION GRIDS

Put a cross in a box when a clue rules someone (or somewhere) out. When only one row is left in each grid, you've cracked it.

WHO?	E1	E2	W2	Still in?
A Max Thornbury				
B Harvey Pike				
C Ivy Chen				
D Ruby Okafor				
E Noah Price				
F Tomasz Nowak				

WHERE?	W1	A1	E3	Still in?
1 Church porch				
2 Boathouse				
3 Hollow oak tree				
4 Bandstand bench box				
5 Cricket pavilion cupboard				

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MAKE YOUR ANSWER CODE

Write the **code word** of the person who took the kite, then the **number** of the hiding place. For example, if it was Tomasz in the church porch, the code would be PUDDLE1 (it wasn't!).

Check it at **conkerburydetectives.co.uk/check.html** (choose **Free printables**, then **The Flying Sausage Dog**). If it's wrong, the checker tells you which clue to look at again, without giving the answer away.

STUCK? HINTS

Only read one hint at a time. Try the case again after each one. Every hint gives away a little bit more.

HINT 1

Start with the footprints (E1). Look at the Shoes line on every suspect card. Cross out anyone who wasn't wearing trainers.

HINT 2

Now Ffion's measuring clue (E2): who is too short to reach the hook? Then read Mr Jolly's statement (W2). Only one suspect is left!

HINT 3

For the hiding place, use the map. Mr Fenwick (W1) rules out one place, Alfie (A1) rules out the places you can only reach by the pond path, and E3 rules out anywhere shorter than 1.8 m.



FFION: "Top tip: do the WHO grid first, then the WHERE grid. And measure twice, cross out once!"

DETECTIVE'S NOTES

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ANSWER PAGE

CASE CLOSED

No peeking! Only read this page once you've made your answer code, or if you're totally stuck after all three hints.

THE ANSWER: DRIZZLE5

Noah Price took Sir Biscuit and hid him in the cricket pavilion cupboard (place 5).

1. **E1, the footprints:** the person wore trainers. Max and Harvey wore wellies and Ruby wore smart shoes, so they're all in the clear.
2. **E2, the high hook:** you had to be at least 130 cm tall. Tomasz is only 124 cm, so he couldn't reach. In the clear.
3. **W2, Mr Jolly:** Ivy was at the ice-cream van the whole time, from 12.30 to 1.00. In the clear.
4. That leaves **Noah Price**: trainers ✓, 134 cm ✓, nobody saw him ✓. His code word is **DRIZZLE**.
5. **Where?** W1: the church porch (1) was locked. A1: nobody used the pond path, so not the boathouse (2) or the hollow oak (3). E3: the bench box (4) is only 1.5 m long, too short for a 1.8 m kite. Only the **cricket pavilion cupboard (5)** is left, and at 2.2 m it is long enough.

WHAT HAPPENED NEXT

Biscuit marched straight to the cricket pavilion, sniffed the cupboard door and sat down. Inside, safe and dry, was Sir Biscuit the Magnificent.

Noah went red. "Did you know the forecast said seventy per cent chance of rain at one o'clock?" he said. "Tissue paper goes soggy in rain. I hid him in the dry so he wouldn't get ruined. I was going to tell Mrs Lark, but then I saw a cloud shaped like a teapot."

It didn't rain at all. At two o'clock, Sir Biscuit the Magnificent flew higher than every other kite on the green and won Best in Show. The real Biscuit barked at him all afternoon, just to show who was boss.

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OFFICIAL CERTIFICATE

CASE CLOSED!

This is to certify that

_____

has solved

THE CASE OF THE FLYING SAUSAGE DOG



and is now an official **Junior Detective** of Conkerbury.

Date

Inspector C. Conkerworth

Inspector Cuthbert Conkerworth

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AFTER THE CASE

EXTENSION QUESTIONS

Use after the answer page. Teacher answers in grey.

THINK LIKE A DETECTIVE

1. Mr Fenwick wasn't a suspect. So why did his statement matter?
   Answer / notes: It ruled out a hiding place: the church porch was locked, so the kite can't be there.
2. Ivy Chen wore trainers and was tall enough to reach the hook. What cleared her?
   Answer / notes: W2: Mr Jolly saw her at the ice-cream van for the whole time, 12.30 to 1.00. That is an alibi.
3. Which single clue ruled out the most suspects?
   Answer / notes: E1, the footprints: it cleared Max, Harvey (wellies) and Ruby (smart shoes).
4. Imagine Alfie had gone home at 12 o'clock. Could you still solve the WHERE part?
   Answer / notes: No. Without A1, the boathouse (4 m) and the pavilion cupboard (2.2 m) are both long enough, so there would be two possible answers. Every clue matters!
5. Noah says he hid the kite to keep it dry. Was that a good idea? What should he have done?
   Answer / notes: Open question. He meant well, but he should have told Mrs Lark straight away instead of letting everyone worry.

MATHS DETECTIVE

1. The hook is 1.6 m high. How many centimetres is that?
   Answer / notes: 160 cm.
2. Noah is 134 cm tall. How much taller is he than the 130 cm he needed?
   Answer / notes: 4 cm.
3. How much longer is the pavilion cupboard than Sir Biscuit the Magnificent?
   Answer / notes: 2.2 m − 1.8 m = 0.4 m, or 40 cm.
4. Put the six suspects in order of height, shortest first.
   Answer / notes: Tomasz 124, Noah 134, Ivy 141, Max 146, Ruby 148, Harvey 152 (cm).

WRITE AND SPEAK

1. Write Ivy Chen's report for the *Conkerbury Chronicle*: "Kite Vanishes on Kite Day!"
   Answer / notes: Look for a headline, the 5 Ws (who, what, where, when, why) and a quote from a witness.
2. Hot-seat Noah. Ask him questions about why he did it and how he felt.
   Answer / notes: Speaking and listening: encourage "why" and "how did you feel" questions.
3. Invent a seventh suspect who is ruled out by exactly one clue. Write their suspect card.
   Answer / notes: Check: the new suspect must fail one clue and pass the others, so the answer stays Noah.

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FOR PLANNING

KS2 CURRICULUM LINKS

Light-touch links to the National Curriculum in England (Years 3 to 6)

Subject	What children practise
English: reading (comprehension)	Drawing inferences and justifying them with evidence; retrieving and recording information from a text; summarising the main ideas; discussing their understanding.
English: spoken language	Taking part in collaborative discussion and role play; giving well-structured explanations; considering and evaluating different viewpoints.
English: writing	Newspaper reports and character profiles (extension activities); planning, drafting and editing.
Maths: measurement	Comparing and converting lengths in metres and centimetres; ordering measurements; simple subtraction with decimals (Year 4 to 5).
Maths: reasoning	Logical reasoning and elimination with grids (Christmas mini case); explaining why only one answer works.
Geography	Using maps, keys and simple compass directions to describe routes and features (the village green map).
PSHE / relationships	Working as a team with clear roles; fairness and not jumping to conclusions about people; honesty (Noah's choice).

WHY LOGIC PUZZLES?

Fair-play mysteries reward careful reading. Children can't guess: every decision has to point back to a sentence in the text. That makes them a natural way to practise inference and evidence, and the "which clue says so?" habit carries straight back into guided reading.

ASSESSMENT IDEAS

- Can the child name the clue that ruled each suspect out?
- Can they explain why the answer is the *only* answer?
- Can they spot what would go wrong if one clue were missing (extension question 4)?

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WORLD BOOK DAY · THURSDAY 4 MARCH 2027

DRESS AS A CONKERBURY DETECTIVE

Easy costumes from clothes you already have



PRIYA

Purple jumper, glasses if you wear them (or draw some on card), hair in plaits if you like, and a notebook and pencil that never leave your hand.



OLLIE

A red football top with a big number 9 (paper and tape work fine), and a magnifying glass, real or the cut-out on the next page.



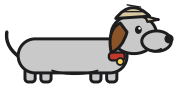
FFION

An orange hoodie, a green beanie and a tape measure in your pocket. Curly hair optional: Ffion's is ginger.



ALFIE

A blue hoodie, a sketchbook and a map you have drawn yourself. That's the whole costume!



BISCUIT

Brown or tan clothes, a red collar, floppy ears on a headband and a deerstalker hat (or the badge on the next page). Sniffing is compulsory.

NO NEED TO BUY ANYTHING

Every costume is everyday clothes plus one prop. The best detective props are home-made: see the cut-out page.

A NOTE ABOUT ALFIE

Alfie is a wheelchair user, and he's the team's Lookout. **Alfie's costume is his blue hoodie, his sketchbook and his map.** Please don't use toy or pretend wheelchairs as a costume prop. Anyone can dress as any of the detectives, and children who use wheelchairs can of course be any character they like.

CLASS IDEA

Set up a "crime scene" in the classroom on World Book Day: a missing book, three suspects and four clues. Let the detectives in costume solve it, using the elimination grid from the Starter Kit.

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CUT OUT AND KEEP

WORLD BOOK DAY PROPS

Print on card if you can. A grown-up should help with the scissors.

CONKERBURY
THE BRAINS
DETECTIVE

CONKERBURY
THE LEGS
DETECTIVE

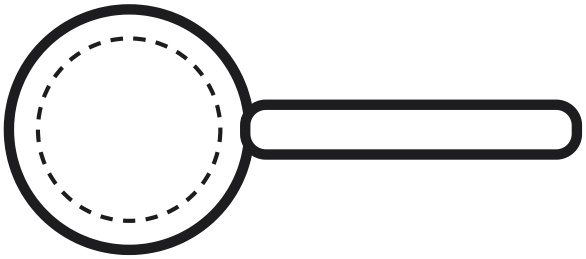
CONKERBURY
THE MEASURER
DETECTIVE

CONKERBURY
THE LOOKOUT
DETECTIVE

CONKERBURY
THE NOSE
DETECTIVE

CONKERBURY
ROOKIE
DETECTIVE

MAGNIFYING GLASS



Cut out, cut out the dashed centre and tape clear plastic behind it (or leave it empty).

DRAW YOUR OWN MAP

ALFIE'S MAP OF _____

N ↑

Tape a badge to a jumper with sticky tape, or a grown-up can add a safety pin. Badges say a role only: no names needed.

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